



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, May 4, 2026
City of Lakewood
6000 Main Street SW
Lakewood, WA 98499

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation recognizing May, 2026 as Asian American, Native Hawaiian, Pacific Islander Heritage Month.

COUNCILMEMBER TALBO PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING MAY, 2026 AS ASIAN AMERICAN, NATIVE HAWAIIAN, PACIFIC ISLANDER HERITAGE MONTH TO FAALUAINA PRITCHARD, ASIA PACIFIC CULTURAL CENTER, ART WANG, ALICE FONG, GLENDA GULDULAO, TUYET NGUYEN, AND RADY OUM.

Proclamation recognizing May 3, 2026 through May 9, 2026 as Water Week.

COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING MAY 3, 2026 THROUGH MAY 9, 2026 AS WATER WEEK TO JOHN KORSMO, LAKEWOOD WATER DISTRICT.

Proclamation recognizing May 11, 2026 through May 17, 2026 as Police Week.

MAYOR BOCCHI PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING MAY 11, 2026 THROUGH MAY 17, 2026 AS POLICE WEEK TO PATRICK SMITH, CHIEF OF POLICE, LAKEWOOD POLICE DEPARTMENT.

Proclamation recognizing May 17, 2026 through May 23, 2026 as Public Works Week.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING MAY 17, 2026 THROUGH MAY 23, 2026 AS PUBLIC WORKS WEEK TO JEFF RIMACK, DIRECTOR OF CITY OF LAKEWOOD PLANNING AND PUBLIC WORKS.

Youth Council Report.

YOUTH COUNCIL MEMBER IRIE HENKLE PROVIDED AN OVERVIEW OF THE 2026 YOUTH SUMMIT. YOUTH COUNCILMEMBER REINIDA BENAVENTE PROVIDED AN UPDATE ON THE YOUTH COUNCIL 2026 ELECTION.

Community Collaboration Update.

SHANNON BENNETT PROVIDED AN UPDATE REGARDING THE LAKEWOOD COMMUNITY COLLABORATION. DANIEL BIRDSAW, TACOMA PIERCE COUNTY HEALTH DEPARTMENT, PROVIDED INFORMATION ON LAKEWOOD COMMUNITY COLLABORATION. HE THANKED THE CITY COUNCIL FOR THEIR PARTNERSHIP AND COLLABORATION.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Jane Keisler, Lakewood resident, spoke about American Lake water levels and quality of water.

Joel Dorran, Lakewood resident, spoke about American Lake water levels and quality of water.

Paul Brice, Lakewood resident, spoke about cannabis shops within the City of Lakewood.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke about the City of Lakewood's Budget.

Mary Castrasho, Lakewood resident, spoke about Councilmember Talbo being the first Filipino woman on the Lakewood City Council.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about Said Joquin and Leonard Thomas.

Haley Ivy, Lakewood resident, spoke about the Edgewater Park Master Plan project.

Helen Wagner, Lakewood resident, spoke about City of Lakewood's code enforcement regarding tree removals.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about asphalt paving concerns relating to Garry Oak Trees in the City of Lakewood.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke about Garry Oak tree removals in the City of Lakewood.

Judith Anderson, spoke about Garry Oak Tree removals in the City of Lakewood.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about City of Lakewood Animal Control at the Lakewood Police Department.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council study session of April 13, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council retreat of April 18, 2026.
- C. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of April 20, 2026.
- D. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$2,477,658.71, for the period of March 14, 2026 through April 15, 2026.
- E. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,774,072.05, for the period of March 16, 2026 through April 15, 2026.
- F. Motion No. 2026-32

Approving the 2025 Transportation Benefit District (TBD) Annual Report.

- G. Motion No. 2026-33

Authorizing the award of a construction contract to Asphalt Patch Systems, Inc., in the amount of \$659,268, for the 2026 Roadway Patching and Drainage Repair Project.

- H. Motion No. 2026-34

Authorizing the award of a construction contract to Sierra Santa Fe Corporation, in the amount of \$341,427.77, for the 2026 Chip Seal Program.

I. Motion No. 2026-35

Authorizing the award of a construction contract to Tucci & Sons, LLC, in the amount of \$684,858.70, for the 112th Street – S Tacoma Way to Steele Overlay Project.

J. Motion No. 2026-36

Authorizing the execution of an interlocal agreement with the Lakewood Water District regarding the construction of roadway improvements and water mains along Kendrick Street SW between 111th Street SW and 108th Street SW.

K. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Planning Commission meeting minutes of April 1, 2026.

COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. CONSENT AGENDA ADOPTED UNANMOUSLY BY VOICE VOTE.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS

This is the date set for a public hearing on the 2026 Carry Forward Budget Adjustment.

There being no public testimony, the public hearing was declared closed at 8:32 P.M.

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 849 Amending Lakewood Municipal Code Chapter 5.60 related to Rental Housing Licensing and Inspection Requirements.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 849. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER.

COUNCIL MEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO AMEND ORDINANCE NO. 849 TO INCLUDE ACCESSORY DWELLING UNIT(S) LOCATED ON THE SAME LOT AS THE PRIMARY RESIDENCE AND WHERE THE OWNER CONTINUES TO RESIDE IN EITHER THE PRIMARY RESIDENCE AND THE OWNER CONTINUES TO RESIDE IN EITHER THE PRIMARY RESIDENCE

OR ACCESSORY DWELLING UNIT. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM. ROLL CALL VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED WITH COUNCILMEMBERS BRANDSTETTER, LAURICELLA AND TALBO VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVES TO AMEND ORDINANCE NO. 849, TO AMEND ARTICLE 5.60.010 DEFINITIONS AS FOLLOWS: "ACCESSORY DWELLING UNIT" or "ADU" MEANS A HABITABLE DWELLING UNIT ADDED TO, CREATED WITHIN, OR DETACHED FROM AND ON THE SAME LOT WITH A SINGLE FAMILY HOUSING UNIT, DUPLEX, TRIPLEX, TOWNHOME, OR OTHER HOUSING UNIT THAT PROVIDES BASIC REQUIREMENTS FOR LIVING, SLEEPING, EATING, COOKING, AND SANITATION AND MEETS THE REQUIREMENTS OF LAKEWOOD MUNICIPAL CODE 18A.40.110(B)(1) FOR ACCESSORY DWELLINGS." SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER. VOICE VOTE TAKEN AND CARRIED, UNANIMOUS VOTE.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO AMEND ORDINANCE NO. 849 TO DELETE SECTION 5.60.080 (C). A RENTAL HOUSING OWNER MAY PROVIDE SELF-CERTIFICATION THAT THEIR RENTAL PROPERTY IS IN COMPLIANCE WITH THE REQUIREMENTS OF THIS TITLE IN LIEU OF CERTIFICATE OF INSPECTION. THE FORM AND CONTENT OF SUCH SELF-CERTIFICATION SHALL BE PROVIDED AND APPROVED BY THE CITY. SECONDED BY MAYOR BOCCHI. ROLL CALL VOTE WAS TAKEN AND FAILED WITH COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM, PEARSON, DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE AND MAYOR BOCCHI VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN ON ORDINANCE NO. 849 AS AMENDED AND CARRIED WITH COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

RESOLUTION

Resolution No. 2026-01 Amending the City of Lakewood's Purchasing Policies. – *continued from April 20, 2026*

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT RESOLUTION NO. 2026-01. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM. VOICE VOTE TAKEN. UNANIMOUS VOTE.

Resolution No. 2026-02 Adopting the adopting the Fiscal Year 2026 Consolidated Annual Action Plan (July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027) for CDBG and HOME programs, including amendments to Fiscal Year 2023, 2024, and 2025 Consolidated Annual Action Plans.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT RESOLUTION NO. 2026-02. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE TAKEN. UNANIMOUS VOTE.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell gave an update regarding visiting Sister Sister, Gimhae in South Korea for the Gaya Cultural Festival and requested guidance from Council on logistics regarding extending an invitation to Sister City, Gimhae for SummerFest.

City Manager Russell responded to the cannabis public comment.

City Manager Russell and City Attorney Wachter provide an update regarding memorandum provided to American Lake - Lake Management Advisory Committee and Work Plan. Discussion ensued.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- May 2, 2026 11 am to 1pm Taste of Asia Pacific featuring Korea, Asia Pacific Cultural Center
- May 12, 2026 6:30 pm, Tillicum/Woodbrook Neighborhood Association meeting
- May 14, 2026 7 pm, Lake City Neighborhood Association meeting
- May 16, 2026 8 am to 12 pm, Youth Fishing Event, American Lake Park
- May 18, 2026 Housing Mini-Academy for Recently Elected Policy Makers

- May 18, 2026 – May 20, 2026 APTA Legislative Conference, Washington, DC

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Council member Pearson reported public concern regarding Pierce Transit terminating the 574 public transportation bus route.

Council member Lauricella reported he attended the climate comprehensive action plan on behalf of the City of Lakewood. He also attended the Downtown Neighborhood Associated meeting and stated he received community feedback regarding possible additions to parks. Lauricella also attended Parks Appreciation Day. He praised the City of Lakewood's new park opening: Wards Park. He also stated he attended the Opioid Abatement Council Meeting. He stated he will attend the Wildfire Smoke and Heat Preparation Workshop. Lauricella thanked Council Member Talbo: better representation within the City of Lakewood. Council member Lauricella addressed change in City Council meeting schedule.

Council member Brandstetter attended the shape executive board meeting to discuss the 2027 budget. Brandstetter addressed public comments received tonight.

Council member Talbo thanked Pierce Transit for providing free transportation for the Youth Summit Event. She reported she will attend the executive leadership housing workshop.

Council member Lindholm addressed public comments made regarding tree enforcement, animal control, and also addressed concerns regarding Pierce Transit terminating the 574 route.

Deputy Mayor Belle thanked the Youth Council and spoke about the proclamations issued. Deputy Mayor Belle suggested the City promote the Community Collaboration human services portal. She reported she is looking forward to attending the Community in Schools of Lakewood Breakfast.

Mayor Bocchi attended the Parks Appreciate Day. He praised the City's new park improvements at Wards Lake Park. The Mayor addressed concerns regarding the Pierce Transit terminating the 574 route.

Councilmember Lauricella and Councilmember Brandstetter will be absent for the Monday 11, 2026 Council meeting.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 10:22 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



JOSIE ATKINS
ACTING CITY CLERK